

JUMPERS KNEE.



Come to think of it—many sports involve jumping, and the explosive power that contributes to efficient jumping is often the difference between elite and amateur athletes. A common issue among athletes is knee pain caused by jumping, particularly in the front of the knee and is termed Jumpers Knee. This is often due to the strain placed on the quadriceps tendon, which connects the powerful quadriceps muscle to the knee. It is frequently seen in middle school kids particularly when in the growth spurt period and caused by improper landing technique and lack of regular, systematic stretching before and after the sporting activity. Sudden increase in intensity of training, change in technique or a sudden return from a break, in training, may also be contributing factors. Lack of sufficient rest, burn out and repetitive stress are also factors to be considered. Prevention of Jumpers Knee is by a multi-modal approach:

- **Students with sudden height gain should not be put through repetitive high intensity jump training during this phase.**
- **Strength and Conditioning experts' help in prescribing individualised exercise program based on current intensity of training strength is important.**

While we heavily focus on improving jump height and power through strength training and plyometrics, the landing technique is equally important, as Improper landing places unnecessary stress on the knees and the ankle

To conclude, coaches must instruct athletes on the following points to prevent improper landing:

- **Land softly on the balls of both feet.**
- **Keep feet shoulder-width apart.**
- **Bend knees and hips to absorb impact.**
- **Avoid sudden twists or movements.**

Halt Sports Injuries (HSI) : An Ortho One Initiative which helps the athletes from injuries by creating awareness through learning session and medical support at subsidised amount for deserving sports person.

(Note: Donation are exempt under 80(G) and CSR Income Tax act)

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